UNIVERSITY OF WATERLOO

January 15th, 2026

To Whom It May Concern,

I am writing to recommend Anay Baid based on his performance in CS445: Software Requirements Specification, a senior-level Computer Science course I taught in Fall 2025. This course is known for its heavy workload and rigor, requiring students to demonstrate both technical and analytical skills.

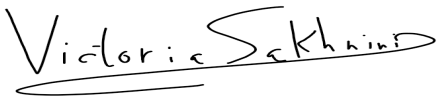
CS445 requires weekly readings and written reflections posted on Piazza, which demand consistent engagement and critical thinking. In addition, the course includes a major group project worth 50% of the final grade, comprising eight detailed deliverables focused on modelling and specifying software requirements. These deliverables are intentionally challenging because they require students to capture complex system details accurately—something even strong students often struggle with. There is also a 5% bonus for extra engagement, such as providing constructive feedback on peers' posts and actively participating in discussions.

It is exceptionally rare for students to achieve a perfect score in CS445. Anay not only earned 100% in the course, but his project work was flawless across all eight deliverables, an achievement I consider nearly impossible given the complexity of requirements modelling. His submissions were thorough and precise, demonstrating a deep understanding of the subject matter. Beyond technical excellence, Anay consistently engaged with the course community, asked insightful questions, met regularly with the teaching assistant, and provided valuable feedback to peers. These behaviours reflect a high level of commitment and professionalism.

In my experience, Anay's performance in CS445 clearly demonstrates his ability to manage a heavy workload while maintaining exceptional quality. The course demands sustained effort and collaboration, and Anay excelled in every aspect. His work ethic, time management, and dedication to learning were evident throughout the term.

Please feel free to contact me if you require any additional information.

Sincerely,



Victoria Sakhnini – CS Associate Professor – Teaching, SE Director, PEng.

(https://cs.uwaterloo.ca/~vsakhnin/)

David R. Cheriton School of Computer Science

The University of Waterloo, Waterloo, Canada